

Thanmay Jayakumar

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EDUCATION

INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY MADRAS
Chennai, India | 2025 - Present
(M.S.) Data Science & AI, NLP

VISVESVARAYA NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY Nagpur, India | 2019 - 2023
(B.Tech) Electronics & Communication Engineering

COURSEWORK

- IIT Madras DA7016: Recent Advances in Generative AI
- Generative AI with Large Language Models [Cert.]
- NVIDIA's Building Transformer-Based Natural Language Processing (NLP) Applications [Cert.]
- IIIT-Hyderabad's Summer School on NLP [Cert.]
- Stanford CS224n: NLP with DL [Course]
- IIT-Madras CS6910: Deep Learning [Course]
- CS6370: Natural Language Processing
- NVIDIA's Fundamentals of Deep Learning [Cert.]
- Convolutional Neural Networks [Course]
- Data Structures and Algorithms [Cert.]
- Linear Algebra • Numerics and Probability

SKILLS

PROGRAMMING LANGUAGES

• Python • C • C++ • MATLAB • Perl (basic)

LIBRARIES

• PyTorch • Tensorflow • NumPy • SciPy • Pandas

SOFTWARE/TOOLS

• Git • Bash • MS Office • Adobe Photoshop
• LaTeX • HuggingFace • OS: Linux, Windows

LANGUAGES

Fluent	English, Tamil, Hindi, Telugu
Intermediate	German, Malayalam, Kannada
Elementary	Chinese, Sanskrit, Indonesian

EXTRACURRICULARS

- **Workshop Coordinator:** Organized and taught various workshops on Data Science under the IEEE VNIT Student Chapter Nagpur.
- **Volunteer:** Mentored junior year students at IvLabs on Deep Learning and NLP research.
- **Graphic Designer:** Member of the Magazine & Literary Club, VNIT Nagpur.
- **Piano & Music Theory:** Grade 5 - Associated Board of the Royal Schools of Music (ABRSM).

EXPERIENCE

AI4BHARAT, IIT MADRAS

Sep 2023 - Present

AI Resident **Advisors** Raj Dabre, Anoop Kunchukuttan, Mitesh Khapra

- Research on developing efficient multilingual LLMs.
- Experience with data collection, pretraining, instruction-tuning.
- [Publication] Released "Airavata", a Hindi instruction-tuned LLM.

IIT KANPUR

May - Aug 2022

Research Intern (SURGE 2022 Intern)

Advisor Vipul Arora

- Aimed at solving the task of Spoken Term Detection (STD) to retrieve queried speech files in an audio database.
- Implemented three different approaches to STD for query localization, classification and location suggestion in a database.
- Analyzed an optimal combination of the above, in order to work towards building a language-agnostic system.

PUBLICATIONS

1. [Paper] **Thanmay Jayakumar**, Mohammed Safi Ur Rahman Khan, Raj Dabre, Ratish Puduppully, Anoop Kunchukuttan. "IndicIFEval: A Benchmark for Verifiable Instruction-Following Evaluation in 14 Indic Languages" (arXiv 2026)
2. [Paper] **Thanmay Jayakumar**, Deepon Halder, Raj Dabre. "Scripts Through Time: A Survey of the Evolving Role of Transliteration in NLP" (ACL 2026)
3. [Tutorial] Anoop Kunchukuttan, Raj Dabre, Rudra Murthy, Mohammed Safi Ur Rahman Khan, **Thanmay Jayakumar**. "Data and Model Centric Approaches for Expansion of Large Language Models to New languages" (EMNLP 2025)
4. [Paper] Deepon Halder, Alan Saji, **Thanmay Jayakumar**, Ratish Puduppully, Anoop Kunchukuttan, Raj Dabre. "RiddleBench: A New Generative Reasoning Benchmark for LLMs" (EACL 2026)
5. [Paper] A global team led by MBZUAI. "CaMMT: Benchmarking Culturally Aware Multimodal Machine Translation" (EMNLP 2025)
6. [Paper] Alan Saji, Jaavid Aktar Husain, **Thanmay Jayakumar**, Raj Dabre, Anoop Kunchukuttan, Ratish Puduppully. "RomanLens: The Role Of Latent Romanization In Multilinguality In LLMs" (ACL 2025)
7. [Paper] Jaavid Aktar Husain, Raj Dabre, Aswanth Kumar, Jay Gala, **Thanmay Jayakumar**, Ratish Puduppully, Anoop Kunchukuttan. "RomanSetu: Efficiently unlocking multilingual capabilities of Large Language Models models via Romanization" (ACL 2024)
Awarded the ACL 2024 Senior Area Chair Award
8. [Paper] A global team led by MBZUAI. "CVQA: Culturally-diverse Multilingual Visual Question Answering Benchmark" (NeurIPS 2024)
9. [Paper] Fauzan Farooqui, **Thanmay Jayakumar**, Pulkit Mathur, Mansi Radke, "Leveraging Linguistically Enhanced Embeddings for Open Information Extraction" (LREC-COLING 2024)
10. [Paper] **Thanmay Jayakumar**, Fauzan Farooqui, Luqman Farooqui, "Large Language Models are legal but they are not: Making the case for a powerful LegalLLM" (NLLP, EMNLP 2023)